the Buddhist view is that the visual sense grasps only colour, the tactile sense grasps only heat, the auditory sense grasps only crackling, and the sense of smell grasps burning. Moreover, the two reliable means of knowledge (sense perception or *pratyaksha* and inference or ***anumana)*** exclusively have their own domains. No entity of a certain type can be the object of two different ***pramanas***. What is perceivable is not inferable and vice versa. The unique, inexpressible particulars that are given in sensory perceptions cannot be the direct objects of awareness involving conceptual construction. This means that if there is a mind-independent reality, it is literally unthinkable. Concepts, such as those of fire and smoke, are products of conceptualisation (***vikalpa***; ***kalpana***) operating on sensory impressions (or, for the idealist ***Vijnanavada***, complexes of simple ideas). Inferences involving smoke and fire operate at this conceptual level, which is indirectly related to the temporary combinations of particular instants.

Acceptance of this view means that the Buddhist cannot know how many reliable means of knowledge there are. If a cognition is not grasped by another cognition but only by itself, and if perception is grasped only by perception and inference only by inference, and if there is no persisting soul that could coordinate different cognitions, then one cannot count the reliable means of knowledge.

Pramanya (the veridicality of knowledge): it is a controversial issue whether when one knows something one must also explicitly know that one knows. Does having a true thought require that one knows its truth? Can we be said to know without subjective certainty? The theory that the conditions that produce cognition are sufficient to produce its truth (*prama*) is the view that truthfulness is intrinsic to knowledge (***svatah pramanya***). The theory